(Recent memory : Can be checked by asking patients about their appetite and then about what they had for breakfast or for dinner the previous evening.

Remote memory : Can be tested by asking patients for information about their childhood that can be verified later.

Immediate memory : Ability to repeat three words immediately and 3 to 5 minutes later)

Intelligence : Intact / Impaired

(General knowledge / Arithmetic ability / Similarities and dissimilarities between paired objects)

Judgment : Intact / impaired

(Judgment is the ability to assess a situation correctly and act appropriately within the situation Personal / Social)

Insight : Present/ partially present / Absent

(Insight is a patient's degree of awareness and understanding about being ill)

Conclusion

The mental status examination is the part of the clinical assessment that describes the sum total of the examiner's observations and impressions of the psychiatric patient at the time of the interview. Whereas the patient's history remains stable, the patient's mental status can change from day to day or hour to hour. The mental status examination is the description of the patient's appearance, speech, actions, and thoughts during the interview. Even when a patient is mute, is incoherent, or refuses to answer questions, the clinician can obtain a wealth of information through careful observation.

Practical 1-8.indd 331 09-03-2020 15:33:11